ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — SOCIAL SCIENCE · CLASS 8 · SET 02

Max. Marks: 60 · The Mastermind Coaching Classes, Jaipur · Alternate correct points / examples to be given full credit

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1×15=15) — 15 marks

Question 1 · Choose the correct option for each sub-part.

1.(i) The United Kingdom is warmer than other places at the same latitude mainly because of the —

(A) Labrador current, a cold current (B) Gulf Stream, a warm ocean current
(C) Suez Canal (D) Tibetan Plateau

Ans: (B) The Gulf Stream carries warm water from near the Equator towards Western Europe.

(ii) The first general elections of independent India were held in —

(A) 1947–48 (B) 1957–58 (C) 1951–52 (D) 1962–63

Ans: (C) India held its first elections on the basis of universal adult franchise in 1951–52.

(iii) The tribal uprising of 1899–1900 led by Birsa Munda is known as the —

(A) Santhal Hul (B) Paika Sangram
(C) Khilafat Movement (D) Ulgulaan

Ans: (D) Ulgulaan means 'great tumult'.

(iv) The Brihadishvara Temple at Thanjavur is well known for its tall vimana and a huge Nandi carved from —

(A) white marble (B) brick and terracotta
(C) a single stone (D) ten separate blocks

Ans: (C) A towering vimana and a monolithic Nandi are its famous features.

(v) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option.

Assertion (A): Public Interest Litigation (PIL) has made courts more accessible to ordinary citizens.

Reason (R): A PIL allows a public-spirited person or group to approach the court on behalf of others who cannot do so themselves.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect
(B) A is incorrect, R is correct
(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A
(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

Ans: (C) R explains A: PIL widens access to justice for the poor and the voiceless.

(vi) Article 21A of the Constitution provides free and compulsory education to children of the age group —

(A) 6 to 14 years (B) 3 to 8 years (C) 10 to 18 years (D) 14 to 21 years

Ans: (A) It was added to make elementary education a Fundamental Right.

(vii) A district has 6,00,000 males and 5,64,000 females. Its sex ratio (females per 1,000 males) is —

(A) 1,064 (B) 564 (C) 9,400 (D) 940

Ans: (D) Sex ratio = (5,64,000 ÷ 6,00,000) × 1,000 = 940.

(viii) Jaipur was planned in 1727 by Sawai Jai Singh II with the help of the architect —

(A) Lala Hardayal (B) Vidyadhar Bhattacharya
(C) Ustad Ahmad Lahori (D) Bishan Singh

> **Ans: (B)** The city follows a grid plan of rectangular blocks.

(ix) Read Statement I and Statement II and select the correct option.
Statement I: Chhatrapati Shivaji was crowned at Raigad in 1674.
Statement II: Sardeshmukhi was a levy of 25 per cent of the revenue of neighbouring territories.

(A) Only I is correct (B) Only II is correct
(C) Both are correct (D) Both are incorrect

> **Ans: (A)** Chauth was 25 per cent; sardeshmukhi was an additional 10 per cent.

(x) Given below are two statements – Assertion (A) and Reason (R). Read them and select the correct option.
Assertion (A): Indian weavers lost their livelihood in the early nineteenth century.
Reason (R): Cheap British machine-made cloth entered India at low duty, while Indian cloth faced heavy duty in Britain.

(A) A is correct, R is incorrect
(B) A is incorrect, R is correct
(C) Both A and R are correct and R is the correct explanation of A
(D) Both A and R are correct but R is not the correct explanation of A

> **Ans: (C)** R explains A: Indian cloth lost both its foreign and home market.

(xi) The Delhi Sultanate was founded in 1206 by —

(A) Iltutmish (B) Qutub-ud-din Aibak
(C) Babur (D) Muhammad Ghori's son

> **Ans: (B)** Aibak, a former slave-general of Muhammad Ghori, became the first Sultan of Delhi.

(xii) During the Question Hour in Parliament, members —

(A) elect the Prime Minister
(B) pass the Budget
(C) punish offenders
(D) ask ministers questions about the working of the government

> **Ans: (D)** It is one way in which the executive is held accountable.

(xiii) A shopkeeper pays ₹12,000 every month to the owner of the shop. In economics this payment is called —

(A) rent (B) wages (C) interest (D) profit

> **Ans: (A)** Rent is the reward for the use of land (and buildings).

(xiv) Coal is classified as a non-renewable resource because —

(A) it is found only in India
(B) it can be grown in farms
(C) it takes millions of years to form and cannot be replaced at the rate we use it
(D) it is available as sunlight

> **Ans: (C)** Nature cannot regenerate it within human timescales.

(xv) Gujarat weavers of fine silk moved to Banaras, which became famous for brocade, with the encouragement of the Mughal emperor —

(A) Aurangzeb (B) Humayun (C) Sher Shah Suri (D) Akbar

> **Ans: (D)** Mughal patronage brought zarī and brocade techniques to Banaras.

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Questions (4×2=8) — 8 marks

Question Nos. 2 to 5 · each carries 2 marks · at least 20 words.

2.(A) Why does the Election Commission enforce the Model Code of Conduct?

Marking points (1 + 1):

- It is a set of guidelines for parties and candidates during elections — 1 mark
- It ensures a level playing field and free and fair elections (e.g. no misuse of government resources) — 1 mark

OR

2.(B) Give two examples each of renewable and non-renewable resources.

Marking points (1 + 1):

- Renewable: sunlight, wind, river water, forests (any two) — 1 mark
- Non-renewable: coal, petroleum, natural gas, minerals (any two) — 1 mark

3. Why are mountains called the 'water towers' of the world?

Marking points (1 + 1):

- They store water as snow and glaciers at great heights — 1 mark
- Melting snow feeds rivers that supply fresh water to the plains below — 1 mark

4.(A) Who appoints the judges of a High Court and in consultation with whom?

Marking points (1 + 1):

- The President of India appoints them — 1 mark
- In consultation with the Chief Justice of India, the Governor of the state and the Chief Justice of the High Court — 1 mark

OR

4.(B) State any two differences between a Fundamental Right and a Fundamental Duty.

Marking points (1 + 1):

- Rights can be enforced through courts, whereas duties are mainly moral and social obligations — 1 mark
- Rights are claims of the citizen; duties are responsibilities towards others and the nation (Article 51A) — 1 mark

5. Who was Ahilyabai Holkar? Mention one of her contributions.

Marking points (1 + 1):

- Ruler of the Holkar kingdom (Indore/Maheshwar) from 1767 to 1795 — 1 mark
- Built and restored many temples, ghats and wells, including the Kashi Vishwanath temple; cared for common people (any one) — 1 mark

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (2×3=6) — 6 marks

Question Nos. 6 and 7 · each carries 3 marks · about 40–60 words.

6.(A) Describe any three features of Indo-Islamic architecture.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- A blend of Islamic building traditions with Indian craftsmanship
- Domes, arches and minarets
- Jalis (lattice screens) for light and air
- Jharokhas and chhatris with floral and geometric motifs

OR

6.(B) Explain any three ways in which the bhakti and Sufi saints promoted harmony in society.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- They taught devotion to one god and criticised empty rituals (e.g. Kabir)
- They rejected caste and religious barriers (e.g. Ravidas, Guru Nanak)
- They composed in simple regional languages understood by ordinary people
- Sufi qawwālīs and shared shrines brought Hindus and Muslims together

7.(A) Explain any three consequences of the Battle of Plassey (1757).

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Robert Clive defeated Siraj-ud-daulah, helped by the betrayal of Mir Jafar
- The East India Company gained control over rich Bengal
- Company used Bengal's revenue to build its army and expand
- Trade turned into political rule; Mir Jafar became a puppet Nawab

O R

7.(B) State any three functions of the Parliament of India.

Marking points (any three, 1 mark each):

- Makes laws on the subjects given in the Constitution
- Approves the Budget and controls government spending
- Questions and keeps a check on the executive
- Can amend the Constitution as provided / debates national issues

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (2×5=10) — 10 marks

Question Nos. 8 and 9 · each carries 5 marks · about 80–100 words.

8.(A) Describe the Quit India Movement under the following heads: slogan, leaders, main events and results.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Launched by Gandhi in August 1942 at the Bombay (Gowalia Tank) session with the call 'Do or Die'
- Britain was at war and the Cripps Mission of 1942 had failed to satisfy Indians
- Top leaders were arrested within hours, so the movement was leaderless and spontaneous
- Aruna Asaf Ali hoisted the flag; Kanaklata Barua and others became martyrs
- Strikes, protests, underground radio and parallel governments appeared in some regions
- Though crushed, it showed that British rule could not continue for long

O R

8.(B) Describe the Kailasha Temple at Ellora and the stepwells of Gujarat and Rajasthan as examples of Indian architecture.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Kailasha Temple: carved out of a single rock from top to bottom at Ellora
- Thousands of tonnes of stone were removed to shape the temple, shrines and courtyard
- Rich sculpture of gods and scenes from epics
- Stepwells (vavs/baoris): deep wells with steps down to water, built for water harvesting
- They also served as cool, shaded social spaces; ornamented with carvings

9. Describe the rise and achievements of the Vijayanagara Empire.

Marking points (any five, 1 mark each):

- Founded in 1336 by the brothers Harihara and Bukka on the Tungabhadra
- Capital Hampi (Vijayanagara) was a rich city with temples, bazaars and palaces
- Krishnadevaraya (r. 1509–29) was its greatest ruler: a conqueror, poet and patron of arts
- Trade through ports, irrigation works and temple building supported the economy
- Defeat by the Deccan Sultanates at the Battle of Talikota in 1565 led to the fall of the capital

SECTION E — Case / Source Based Questions (4×4=16) — 16 marks

Question Nos. 10 to 13 · each carries 4 marks (1+1+2).

10. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Residents of a town noticed that the river near their colony had turned brown and smelly after a factory upstream began releasing waste. A group of schoolchildren and a local teacher wrote a letter to the High Court, describing the damage to fish, drinking water and health. The Court treated the letter as a petition in the public interest and ordered an inquiry into the factory.

(10.1) What type of legal case is described in the passage?

> A Public Interest Litigation (PIL).

(10.2) Which Fundamental Right is affected by polluted water? (Name the right or the Article.)

> The right to life and a healthy environment (Article 21).

(10.3) Name one court or tribunal where such an environmental dispute can be taken up, and state one reason why PIL is useful.

> (1) High Court / Supreme Court / National Green Tribunal (any one); (1) PIL lets people who cannot afford or approach courts themselves get justice through public-spirited persons.

11. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> The table gives details of two cities.

City	Population	Area (sq km)
City P	24,00,000	120
City Q	6,00,000	100

(11.1) Calculate the population density of City P.

> 24,00,000 ÷ 120 = 20,000 persons per sq km.

(11.2) Calculate the density of City Q and say which city is more crowded.

> 6,00,000 ÷ 100 = 6,000 per sq km; City P is more crowded.

(11.3) Suggest two measures that the planners of City P can take to make life easier for its residents.

> Any two (1 mark each): improve public transport / metro; build affordable housing; develop green spaces; manage waste and water supply; plan satellite towns to reduce pressure.

12. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> Rani of Jhansi's husband died without a natural heir, and the Rani adopted a son as the Hindu tradition permitted. The British, however, refused to recognise the adopted child and brought the state under Company rule, under a policy attributed to the Governor-General Lord Dalhousie. Her anger and that of many other rulers and soldiers surfaced in 1857, and she fought bravely against the British forces.

(12.1) Name the policy under which Jhansi was annexed.

> Doctrine of Lapse.

(12.2) Who introduced this policy as Governor-General?

> Lord Dalhousie.

(12.3) How did this policy contribute to the Revolt of 1857? State two points.

> (1) Rulers lost their states and rights when they had no natural male heir, creating anger and fear; (1) deposed rulers and their supporters, like Rani Lakshmibai, joined the rebellion.

13. Read the paragraph given below and answer the questions that follow: (1+1+2=4)

> When the great centres of learning at Nālandā and Vikramaśhilā were destroyed in the late 12th century, many scholars were scattered and an important learning ecosystem was lost. Yet education did not stop. Gurukulas, temple schools, pāṭhaśhālās and madrasās kept teaching reading, writing, arithmetic and religious texts, while guilds trained young artisans through apprenticeship.

(13.1) Name the two centres of learning that were destroyed.

> Nālandā and Vikramaśhilā.

(13.2) Name any one local system of education mentioned in the passage.

> Gurukulas / temple schools / pāṭhaśhālās / madrasās / guild apprenticeship (any one).

(13.3) What does this show about the strength of Indian society? Give two points.

> (1) Learning continued in decentralised, local forms and survived upheaval; (1) it shows resilience — communities and guilds passed on knowledge and skills.

SECTION F — Map Based Question (1×5=5) — 5 marks

Question No. 14 · 5 marks.

14. On the Political outline Map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following places using appropriate symbols/signs: (5×1=5)

(I) Bardoli
(II) Mount Abu (Dilwara Temples)
(III) Sanchi
(IV) Mysuru
(V) Bishnupur
(VI) Chauri Chaura

The following questions are for Visually Impaired students only, in lieu of Question No. 14. Answer any five questions:

(I) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Bardoli located? 1
(II) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Mount Abu located? 1
(III) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Sanchi located? 1
(IV) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Mysuru located? 1
(V) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Bishnupur located? 1
(VI) In which present-day Indian state/UT is Chauri Chaura located? 1

1 mark for each correctly located and labelled place (any five); a position within about 150 km of the true location is acceptable. For Visually Impaired candidates: 1 mark for each correct state/UT (any five).

- (I) Bardoli — **Gujarat**
- (II) Mount Abu (Dilwara Temples) — **Rajasthan**
- (III) Sanchi — **Madhya Pradesh**
- (IV) Mysuru — **Karnataka**
- (V) Bishnupur — **West Bengal**
- (VI) Chauri Chaura — **Uttar Pradesh**

